PROFESSIONAL SHORT COURSE
ABUJA · NIGERIA



DATA-LEAD AFRICA · TRAINING

Proposal & Grant *Writing*

A practical, hands-on course that turns your ideas into concept notes, proposals and budgets that win funding.

Where we work: Nigeria, Benin, Ghana, Côte d'Ivoire, Chad and Guinea-Bissau.

DURATION	FORMAT	FEE
3 Days	Onsite & Online	NGN 150,000



Participants at a Data-Lead Africa training in Abuja.

ABOUT THE COURSE

The craft of winning funding

This course equips NGO staff, researchers and development professionals with the practical skills to write proposals that win. From reading a call to designing a logframe, writing the narrative and building a compliant budget, you learn a clear, repeatable process for turning ideas into funded projects.

Data-Lead Africa is a research and training consulting firm working across monitoring and evaluation, data analytics, data science training and strategic consulting. We combine statistics, research methods and technology to turn data into insight, taught by a team of experienced professionals.

06	3 Days	01	100%
CORE MODULES	HANDS-ON	REAL PROPOSAL	PRACTICAL

Trusted on assignments across **37 Nigerian jurisdictions** *and* **six countries of West Africa**, *including the evaluation of a* **USD 470 million** *Global Fund portfolio.*

PARTNERS & CLIENTS WE HAVE WORKED WITH

USAID · MERCY CORPS · jhpiego · Save the Children · JICA · ACTION AGAINST HUNGER / ACTION CONTRE LA FAIM · United Nations Trust Fund to End Violence Against Women · Nigeria Joint Response for Humanitarian Relief Alliances (NJR)



WHY IT MATTERS

Good work deserves funding. This course helps you make the *case that wins it.*

Funding goes to those who can make a clear, credible case. You will learn a repeatable process for turning ideas into concept notes, proposals and budgets that funders trust.

THE REVIEWER'S MIND

How reviewers read your proposal

Your proposal is not read in a vacuum. It is read by a busy expert working through a pile of applications against a fixed set of criteria. Understanding how they read is half the battle, and you will learn to write for it.

1. **Skim**
   A few minutes per proposal. Clear structure and a sharp summary earn early goodwill.

2. **Score**
   Point by point against a fixed rubric. Each criterion must be easy to find and answer.

3. **Compare**
   Ranked against every other proposal. Small weaknesses decide close calls.



Reviewers decide quickly. Clarity earns their attention.

WHAT REVIEWERS REWARD

- Clear fit with the funder's priorities
- A real problem, backed by evidence
- A logical theory of change
- Realistic, well-justified budgets
- Measurable outcomes and a credible team
- Full compliance with the guidelines

WHAT COSTS YOU POINTS

- Vague aims and buzzwords
- Ignoring the funder's stated criteria
- Inflated claims with no evidence
- Padded or unexplained budgets
- A weak or missing evaluation plan
- Late, incomplete or off-template files

THE TAKEAWAY

Make every criterion easy to find, write for a skim-reader first, and never lose cheap points on compliance. You are not just writing a proposal, you are making a busy reviewer's decision easy.

THE REVIEWER'S MIND, CONTINUED

Write to the scorecard

Most funders score proposals against a rubric. When you know roughly how the points are shared, you know where to invest your effort. A typical weighting looks like this.



The lesson: spend most of your time on relevance and technical approach, make every criterion easy to find, and never lose easy points on compliance.

WHO THIS COURSE IS FOR

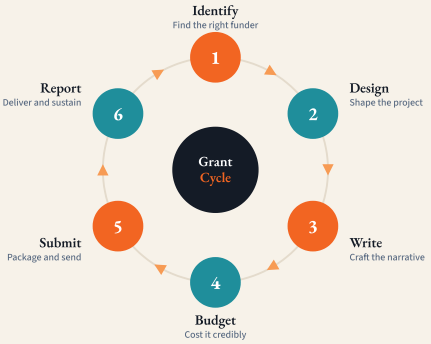
Whether you are applying for your first grant or you write proposals regularly, this course gives you a dependable method and the confidence to use it. No prior experience is required.

- NGO & nonprofit staff
- Researchers
- Programme managers
- M&E officers
- Fundraising teams
- Consultants

THE PROCESS

The grant journey, across three days

Every funded project moves through the same six stages. Over three intensive days, you will practise all six, from finding the right funder to a submission-ready proposal.



HOW THE THREE DAYS ARE STRUCTURED

DAY 1

Foundations & the Call

- Grants & the funding landscape
- Reading calls & donor requirements

DAY 2

Designing & Writing

- Designing a winning project
- Writing the proposal

DAY 3

Budget, Submission & Capstone

- Budgeting & financial planning
- Review, submission & beyond
- Your capstone proposal

DESIGNING RESULTS

From activities to impact

Funders want a clear line from what you do to the change you create. That logic is the results chain, and it drives your logframe.

Inputs
What you invest

›

Activities
What you do

›

Outputs
What you produce

›

Outcomes
What changes

›

Impact
The lasting difference

THE LOGICAL FRAMEWORK (LOGFRAME) AT A GLANCE

	NARRATIVE SUMMARY	INDICATORS	VERIFICATION	ASSUMPTIONS
Goal	The long-term impact	Impact indicators	National data, evaluations	External factors hold
Outcome	The change you cause	Outcome indicators	Surveys, assessments	Outputs are used
Outputs	What you deliver	Output indicators	Activity records	Activities completed
Activities	What you do	Milestones, budget	Work plans, reports	Resources available

You will build a results chain and a logframe for your own project.

STRUCTURE

Anatomy of a winning proposal

A strong full proposal has eight parts that work together. You will draft each one.

01 **Executive summary**
The whole proposal in one page

02 **Problem & needs**
The need, backed by evidence

03 **Goal & objectives**
What success looks like

04 **Theory of change**
How change will happen

05 **Activities & work plan**
What you will do, and when

06 **M&E framework**
How you will measure results

07 **Budget & narrative**
What it costs, and why

08 **Sustainability**
What lasts after the grant

Concept note first

Many funders ask for a short concept note before a full proposal. You will learn to write a sharp two-page concept note that opens the door, then expand it into the full structure above.

THE BUDGET

Build budgets funders trust

A credible budget tells the same story as your narrative, in numbers. Here is how a typical project budget breaks down.



Personnel	35%
Programme activities	30%
Admin & overhead	13%
Equipment & supplies	12%
Monitoring & evaluation	10%

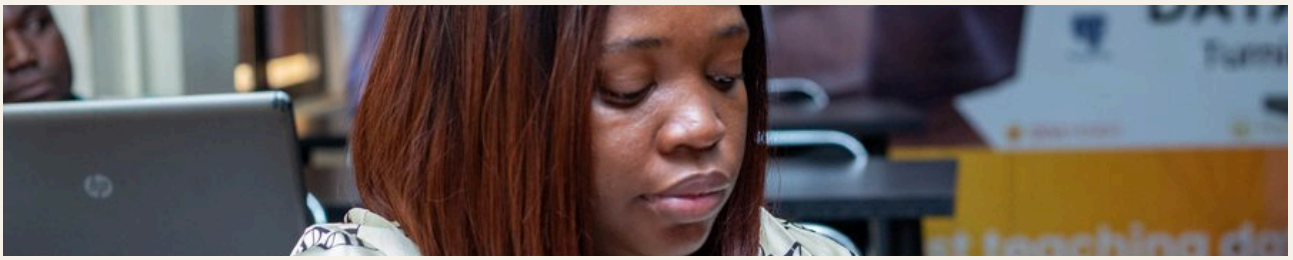
Illustrative split only. Every funder and project differs, and you will learn to tailor yours.

What makes a budget win

- Tie every cost to an activity in your work plan
- Write a narrative that justifies each line
- Keep overhead within the funder's allowed rate
- Show co-funding and value for money

THE CURRICULUM

What you will master



01

Grants and the Funding Landscape GETTING ORIENTED

Understand the funding ecosystem and where your work fits within it.

How grants and donor funding work · Foundations, bilateral, multilateral and government funders · Finding and tracking the right opportunities

02

Reading Calls and Donor Requirements READING THE CALL

Understand exactly what a funder is asking for before you write a word.

Reading calls for proposals, RFPs and RFAs · Eligibility, compliance and submission rules · Aligning your idea with donor priorities

03

Designing a Winning Project PROJECT DESIGN

Turn an idea into a clear, credible project a funder can support.

Problem statements and needs assessment · Theory of change, logframes and results frameworks · Objectives, activities, outcomes and indicators

04

Writing the Proposal THE NARRATIVE

Write concept notes and proposals that are clear, persuasive and complete.

Structuring a strong concept note and full proposal · Clear, persuasive technical narratives · Work plans, methodology and sustainability

05

Budgeting and Financial Planning THE NUMBERS

Build budgets funders trust, and justify every line.

Realistic, donor-compliant budgets · Budget narratives and cost justification · Co-funding, value for money and compliance

06

Review, Submission and Beyond WINNING AND AFTER

Polish, submit, and prepare for the grant that follows.

Reviewing, editing and strengthening your proposal · Submission logistics and avoiding common rejections · Reporting, compliance and donor relationships

Applied Capstone

You finish with a complete, submission-ready concept note or proposal responding to a real call, ready to send to a funder.

HOW IT WORKS & ENROLMENT

Everything you need to join

A hands-on, mentor-led course taught by practitioners who win and manage real grants.

Expert-led sessions
Learn from practitioners who win and manage real grants.

Onsite and online
Attend in person in Abuja or join from anywhere online.

Peer-review sessions
Review real proposals with peers and strengthen your own.

Real call-based practice
Work on an actual call for proposals, from start to finish.

Applied capstone
Finish with a submission-ready concept note or proposal.

Tools & good to know

- Microsoft Word
- Excel
- Logical Framework
- Theory of Change
- Budget templates

Format	**Onsite and online**
Come with	**A real call or project idea**
Materials	**Templates and samples provided**
Certificate	**Awarded on completion**

No special software needed. A laptop with a word processor and spreadsheet is enough.

How to enrol

1 **Register**
Complete the short enrolment form.

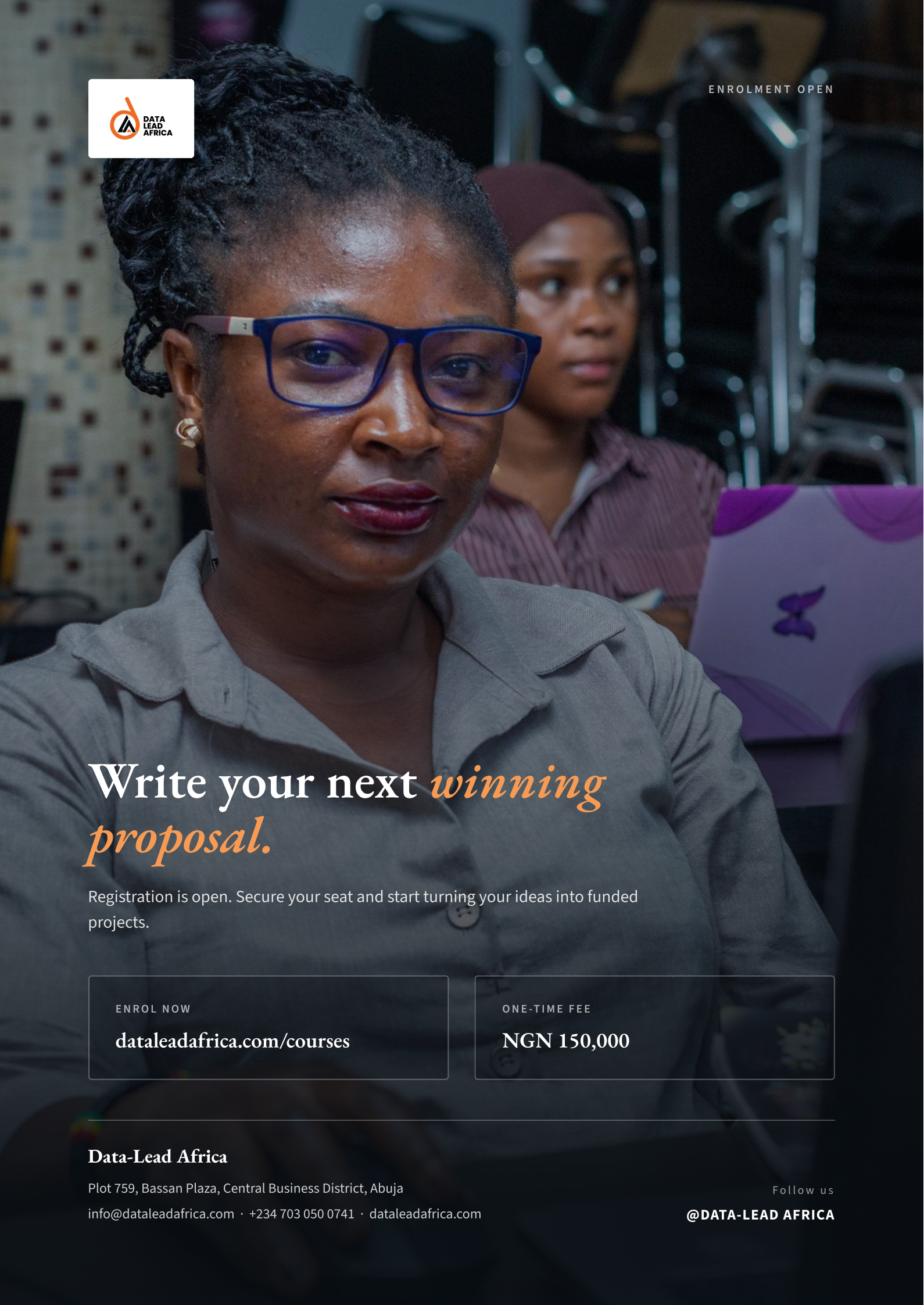
2 **Reserve your seat**
Confirm your place with the one-time payment.

3 **Begin**
Receive your welcome pack and join the cohort.

ONE-TIME FEE

NGN 150,000

Covers the full course: expert-led sessions, templates, peer reviews, real call-based practice and your capstone.



ENROLMENT OPEN

Write your next *winning proposal.*

Registration is open. Secure your seat and start turning your ideas into funded projects.

ENROL NOW

dataleadafrica.com/courses

ONE-TIME FEE

NGN 150,000

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